

Tokuo Aomi (青海 徳生) — Meeting 29 Jul 2026

Advance questions sent to Tokuo, for his preparation

(English reference copy of `tokuo_aomi_meeting_prep_questions_jp.md`, the document actually sent.)

Thanks for the earlier conversation — looking forward to speaking again on the 29th.

This meeting is not about deciding anything. The main goal is simply to get to know Tokuo and Sugano Organic better. The biomass CHP idea was raised earlier, but rather than picking up where that left off, we want to set it aside for now and instead spend real time learning how he currently works.

If there's anything we can genuinely help with, we'd like to. The aim is for him to come away feeling that teaming up makes things stronger for him — not that we're asking something of him. Start by listening.

Below are some of the things we'd like to ask on the day — if something feels hard to answer, or he hasn't thought about it yet, that's completely fine to say.

1. Understanding his work today

- How are Sugano Organic's products (clothing, nature sounds) actually made? Materials, process?
- What's the current pace of production — solo, with family, with other collaborators?
- What parts of the work does he find most rewarding, and what parts are hardest?

2. How the business/sales side works

- How are products sold today (direct sales, online, wholesale to shops, markets/events, word of mouth)?
- Who are the customers, roughly — local vs. outside the village, domestic vs. international?
- What's working well in the current setup, and what would he change if he could?

3. Where he wants this to go

- What's his vision for Sugano Organic going forward — grow it, or keep it close to its current scale and character?
- Are there specific obstacles right now — funding, time, labor, equipment, distribution/reach?

4. What we could actually offer

- If our project (forestry / energy / AI data center) connected with his work, what would genuinely feel like real support to him — his honest take, not ours?
 - Could be funding, help with PR/storytelling and reach, a link to the forest co-op, or something else entirely — anything small is worth mentioning.
 - (Note: the earlier biomass power/heat idea using his own forest is still nothing more than a draft under consideration. Happy to go deeper on it today or later, if and when he's interested.)
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To repeat: this isn't a meeting meant to land on conclusions. The goal is to get to know him and his work, and think together about how partnering could make both of us stronger.

Related docs

- Japanese (sent to Tokuo): `tokuo_aomi_meeting_prep_questions_jp.md`
- Background/full technical proposal (deliberately not the focus of this meeting): `../../Docs extra/CHP biomass/sugano_organic_biomass_proposal.md`
- Meeting notes: `meeting_tokuo_aomi.md`